RecoverMama
BECAUSE MOM MATTERS TOO

FREE WITH YOUR NIGHT SHIFT PILLOW

The 3am *Neck Reset*

Six gentle moves for the feed, the bed and the morning. Two minutes each. One free hand is enough.



START HERE

Why your neck feels like this

It isn't in your head. It's the math of looking down at someone you love, eight to twelve times a day.

10 lb

What your head weighs when it sits level over your shoulders.

60 lb

How heavy it can feel to your neck looking down at about 60° (Hansraj, 2014).

3 to 6h

Roughly how long a day a new mom spends looking down: feeds, burps, phone at 3am.

Hold anything heavy for hours and the muscles holding it get tired and tight. That's what happens across the back of your neck and the tops of your shoulders. Meanwhile the small muscles at the front of your neck, the ones that hold your head up straight, barely get used.

So the goal is simple: **loosen what's been holding on all day, wake up what's been switched off, and give your neck a better night.** That's all this guide does.

How to use it

MOMENT 1

During the feed

2 moves you can do with the baby on you. Seated, one hand.

MOMENT 2

In bed, before sleep

2 moves lying down, plus how to settle onto your pillow.

MOMENT 3

First thing in the morning

2 moves before you pick anyone up.

The 4 rules

1. **Slow beats strong.** Every move is gentle. If you're straining, do less.
2. **Breathe out on the stretch.** Your shoulders drop on the exhale.
3. **Stretch, never pain.** A mild pull is right. Sharp, pinching or tingling means stop.
4. **Any day counts.** Do one moment, not all three. Something beats nothing.

MOMENT 1

During the feed

Seated, baby on you, one hand free.
Do these once per feed, any feed.



1 The Chin Glide

5 SLOW REPS · HOLD 3 BREATHS

1. Sit back against the chair. Look straight ahead at the wall, not down.
2. Glide your chin straight back, like making a double chin. Your head moves back, not down.
3. Hold for 3 slow breaths, then let it ease forward. Repeat 5 times.

> **You'll feel:** a light stretch at the base of your skull and the front of your neck switching on. That's the "head up straight" muscle waking up.



2 The Shoulder Melt

3 ROUNDS · WITH YOUR BREATH

1. Breathe in through your nose and lift both shoulders up toward your ears.
2. Hold for a second at the top.
3. Breathe out slowly through your mouth and let your shoulders drop, heavy, like putting down shopping bags.

> **You'll feel:** the tops of your shoulders let go. Most moms notice they were holding them up the whole feed.

The 3-breath habit: eyes up

Every time you switch sides or burp, lift your eyes to the far wall for 3 breaths and let your head follow back to level. It undoes the downward hang a few times an hour without adding a single minute to your day.

MOMENT 1 · BONUS

Fix the setup, save your neck

Moves help. A better position helps all day. These five changes take seconds and add up fast.

1. **Bring baby up to you, not you down to baby.** Stack a pillow under the baby until their mouth is level with your chest. Your back should touch the chair.
2. **Prop the elbow.** A cushion under the arm holding the baby means your shoulder isn't carrying their weight for 30 minutes.
3. **Feet up.** A stool, a box, a stack of books. It tips your hips back so you stop curling forward.
4. **Switch your gaze side.** If you always look down to the left, your neck always twists the same way. Swap which side you sit on in bed and which shoulder you burp on.
5. **Phone at eye level.** At 3am, hold the phone up in front of your face instead of in your lap. Same scroll, a fraction of the load.



Carrying a car seat? Hold it in front of you with both hands, close to your body, or hook it on your forearm against your hip. One hand down at your side pulls your whole neck and shoulder sideways.

MOMENT 2

In bed, before sleep

Lying down, lights low. About 2 minutes, then straight to sleep.



3 Slow Yes, Slow No

10 NODS · 5 TURNS EACH WAY

1. Lie on your back, head in the low middle of your pillow.
2. Make 10 tiny "yes" nods, small and slow. Your head barely leaves the pillow.
3. Then turn your head slowly to the left and right, only as far as feels easy. 5 each way.

> **You'll feel:** the stiffness from the day loosen without any stretch at all. Small and slow is the whole trick.



4 The Open Book

5 EACH SIDE · BREATHE OUT AS YOU OPEN

1. Lie on your side, knees bent, both arms straight out in front of you, palms together.
2. Breathe out and slowly sweep your top arm up and over toward the other side, letting your eyes follow your hand. Keep your knees together.
3. Rest there for 2 breaths, then close the book. 5 times, then roll over and do the other side.

> **You'll feel:** your chest and upper back open, the exact opposite of the feeding hunch.

Then settle in

On your back: head in the low center. **On your side:** move onto a raised side wing so your head stays level with your spine, and let your bottom arm rest in front of you in the arm cutout instead of under the pillow. Give it two nights; a new shape always feels new at first.

MOMENT 3

First thing in the morning

Before you lift the baby, the car seat or the laundry. About 2 minutes.



5 The Ear to Shoulder Release

30 SECONDS EACH SIDE · SEATED

1. Sit on the edge of the bed. Hold the edge of the mattress with your left hand to keep that shoulder down.
2. Tip your right ear toward your right shoulder. Rest your right hand on your head for a little extra weight. No pulling.
3. Breathe slowly for 30 seconds, then switch sides.

> **You'll feel:** a long stretch down the side of your neck into the top of your shoulder. That's the muscle that does the most holding.



6 The Doorway Opener

HOLD 30 SECONDS · 2 ROUNDS

1. Stand in a doorway. Place your palms on each side of the frame, a little above shoulder height.
2. Step one foot forward and lean gently through until you feel a stretch across the front of your chest.
3. Keep your chin level and breathe for 30 seconds. Step back, shake it out, do it once more.

> **You'll feel:** your chest open and your shoulders sit back where they belong. Tight chest muscles are half of what pulls you into a hunch.

Short on time? The 60-second version

3 Chin Glides, 1 Shoulder Melt, 1 Doorway Opener. Done before the kettle boils.

STICK THIS ON THE FRIDGE

Your 7-night reset

Tick a box when you do a moment. Rate your neck when you wake up. By night 7 you'll see your own pattern.

Night	Feed moves 1+2	Bed moves 3+4	Morning moves 5+6	Neck on waking 1 stiff · 5 easy
Night 1	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 2	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 3	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 4	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 5	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 6	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5
Night 7	☐	☐	☐	1 2 3 4 5

All six at a glance

FEED

1 · Chin Glide

Chin straight back, 5 × 3 breaths

2 · Shoulder Melt

Up on the inhale, drop on the exhale, 3 ×

BED

3 · Slow Yes, Slow No

10 tiny nods, 5 easy turns each way

4 · Open Book

On your side, open the top arm, 5 each side

MORNING

5 · Ear to Shoulder

Hold the bed, tip the ear, 30 s each

6 · Doorway Opener

Palms on the frame, step through, 30 s × 2

LOOK AFTER YOURSELF

When to check in with a pro

These moves are gentle comfort stretches, not treatment. Your body has just done something huge, so listen to it.

Stop and talk to your doctor or a physical therapist if you notice:

- Numbness, tingling or weakness running down your arm or into your hand
- Headaches that keep coming back or won't ease
- Pain that's getting worse week to week, or wakes you up on its own
- Pain after a fall, a bump or a sudden jolt
- Any dizziness, or pain together with a fever

Had a C-section or a tough birth? Check with your provider before the Open Book (move 4) and skip anything that pulls on your scar. A postpartum physical therapist is one of the best people a new mom can see. Many moms say they wish they'd gone sooner.

FROM ALL OF US

Your neck worked all day. Give it the night.

You spend every hour looking after someone else. This is two minutes that's just for you. Do what you can, skip what you can't, and let your Night Shift Pillow handle the rest while you sleep.

Questions? Just reply to your order email. A real person reads every one.



This guide shares general comfort and posture tips for adults. It is not medical advice and does not diagnose, treat or prevent any condition. Stop any move that causes pain. © 2026 RecoverMama · recovermama.com